66 Dy Dysprosium

66 66 97

State: Solid
Discovery: 1886

Fergusonite

This mineral contains tiny amounts of dysprosium.

Dysprosium reacts more easily with air and water than most other lanthanide metals. Although it was discovered in 1886, it took until the 1950s to purify it. This metal is often used with neodymium to produce magnets that are used in **car batteries**, wind turbines, and generators.

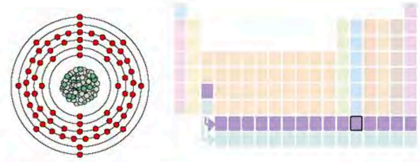
This pure metal remains shiny at room temperature.

Laboratory sample of pure dysprosium

Some hybrid car batteries contain dysprosium.

Hybrid car battery

67 Ho Holmium



67 67 98

State: Solid
Discovery: 1878

The Swedish chemist Per Teodor Cleve named holmium after the Swedish city of Stockholm. Pure holmium can produce a strong magnetic field and is therefore used in magnets. Its compounds are used to make lasers, and to colour glass and artificial jewels, such as **cubic zirconia**.

This artificial gemstone is coloured red by small amounts of holmium.

Red zirconia gemstone

Bright, silver shine

Laboratory sample of pure holmium